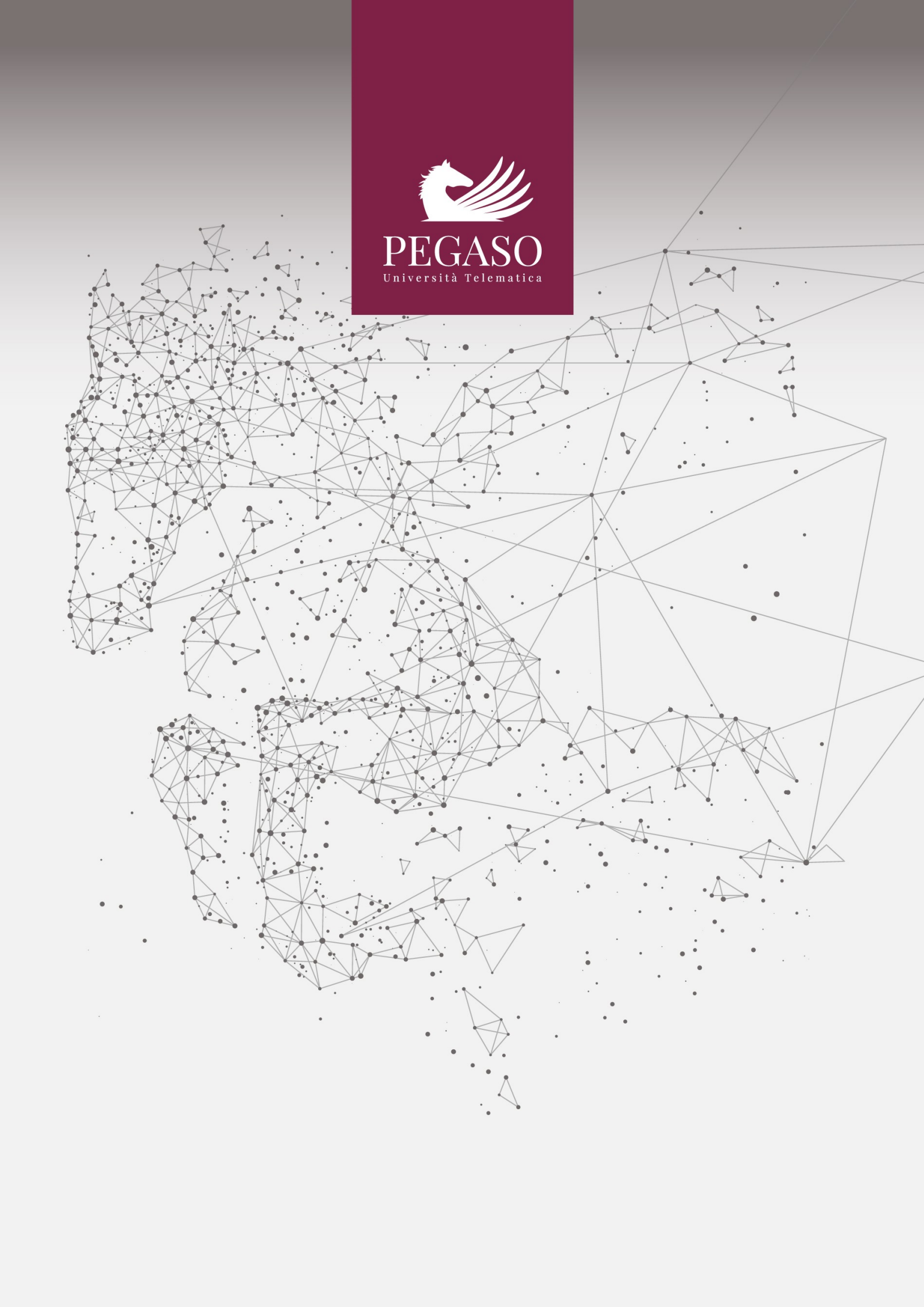

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1. Future Simple

What is often called the Future Simple is formed by the modal verb **will** and the main verb in the infinitive. It should be remembered that **will** has only one form for all subjects (like all other modal verbs).

I will help you with your presentation.

We will study for the exam together tomorrow.

Will + infinitive

Negative: **will + not + infinitive**

Interrogative (invert the subject and will): **will + subject + infinitive**

Contractions in the Future Simple

We often contract the **subject** and **WILL** in affirmative sentences:

I will	I'll
you will	you'll
he will she will it will	he'll she'll it'll
we will	we'll
they will	they'll

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In negative sentences, we may contract **WILL** with **NOT**, in this way:

I will not	I won't
you will not	you won't
he will not she will not it will not	he won't she won't it won't
we will not	we won't
they will not	they won't

In questions there are no contractions.

In short answers there are no contractions in the affirmative. However, the contraction of will + not in the negative short answer is possible.

Will she accept your offer? No, she won't.

The Future simple is used in a variety of ways:

1. It is used for decisions we for the future spontaneously as we speak.

I'll buy this dress because it is the right color, don't you think so?

2. It is used for promises and offers we make for the future:

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I'll call you this evening when I land in Chicago, I promise.

We'll take the rubbish out for you, don't worry.

3. It is used to talk about future events as simple facts:

I will be 45 next month on my birthday.

She will be in the office until 6:00pm so give her a call anytime before then.

4. It is also used to make predictions about the future when the prediction is made based on person opinion, experience or belief:

I am sure she will love that bag.

They will pass the exam because I know them to be great students.

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2. Future Continuous

Will be + verb + -ing

Negative form: **will + not + verb = -ing** (will + not contraction = won't)

Interrogative form (invert the subject and will): **will + subject + be + verb + -ing**

We use the future continuous (will be + verb + -ing) to say that an action will be in progress at a certain time in the future.

Compare these two situations:

1. Please come at around 7.30. We'll have dinner at 8.00.

(= we will start dinner at 8.00)

2. Don't phone between 7.00 and 8.30, as we'll be having dinner.

(- at 8.00 we will be in the middle of the dinner)[1]

In the same way as with Future Simple we use the contracted form (subject + will in the affirmative AND will + not in the negative), especially in spoken English.

Examples of the **affirmative**:

At 10 am tomorrow,

- I will be sleeping (I'll…)
- you will be working (you'll…)
- she will be studying (you'll….)
- he will be cooking (he'll …)
- we will be eating breakfast (we'll…)
- they will be traveling (they'll….)

Examples of the **negative**:

When John gets home,

- I will not be working (I won't be ...)
- you will not be reading (you won't be ...)
- she will not be studying (she won't be ...)
- it will not be snowing (it won't be ...)
- we will not be watching TV (we won't be...)

[1] C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, *English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition*, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020 (138)

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- they will not be sleeping (they won't be ...)

Examples of the **interrogative**:

Remember that in the interrogative form (questions), no contraction is possible.

'Yes / no' questions:

Will you be having dinner at 9:00 this evening? Yes, I will.

Will he be having a holiday in Aruba next 15 June? No, he will not (won't).

When she arrives at the party,

- will you be cooking?

- will he be eating?

- will we be drinking?

- will it be snowing?

'Wh' questions:

Next Monday afternoon,

- where will you be working?

- what will he be doing?

- why will we be studying about monkeys in the course?

- who will you be talking to on the conference call?

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3. Future Perfect Simple

Will + have + past participle

Negative: **will + not + have + past participle**

Interrogative (invert the subject and will): **will + subject+ have + past participle**

- The rain will have stopped by this afternoon.
- Some people think that sea levels will have risen by as much as a metre in 50 years' time.
- Laura won't have arrived before dinner, so I'll leave some food in the oven for her.
- When will they have learned enough English to be able to communicate fluently?

We use the future perfect to say something will be finished before a certain time in the future. The start time of the action is not clear but the completion of the action is sometime before the certain future time indicated.

This certain future time is frequently indicated with the following time expressions:

by Saturday / March / 2030, etc.

in two weeks / months, etc.

by + a time expression = at the latest.

within + six months (a period of time) / six months' time.[2]

Examples of the **affirmative**:

By six pm tonight,

- I will have finished this book.
- you will have studied all the English tenses.
- she will have cooked dinner.
- he will have arrived.
- we will have met Julie.
- it will have stopped raining.

Examples of the **negative and interrogative**:

By next week,

[2] C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, *English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition*, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020 (138)

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- I will not have finished this book.
- you will not have studied the English tenses
- she will not have cooked dinner
- he will not have arrived
- they will not have left Japan
- will they have left Japan by Tuesday?
- will she have cooked dinner by 9:00pm?

Exercise

Complete the sentence using the future perfect or future continuous.

Ex. The film starts at 7.00, but I won't arrive until 7.15. When I arrive at the cinema, the film will have started. (start)

1. The flight to Geneva takes off at 9.00 and lands at 10.30.
At 10.00 they …….to Geneva. (fly)

2. I usually save €200 a month.
By the end of the year, I …….€2,400. (save)

3. Rebecca leaves at 6.30. It takes her an hour to get to work.
At 7.00 tomorrow, she ……to work. (drive)

4. The meeting starts at 2.00 and finishes at 3.30.
Don't call me at 2.30, because we ……..meeting. (have)

5.. Sam is paying for his car. The last payment is in May.
By June, he …… for his car. (pay)

6. Their last exam is on 25th May.
By the end of May, they …….. their exams. (finish)

7. She writes a chapter of her novel a week. This week she's on chapter five.

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By the end of this week, she ……..five chapters. (write)

8. Sonia is usually at the gym between 6.30 and 7.30.

There's no point phoning Sonia now. It's 7.00 and she at the gym. ……..(work out)[3]

Complete these predictions regarding mobile technology by putting the verb in the future continuous or future perfect simple.

In a year's time ...

9. ... very few people in the developed world _____(use) credit cards because mobile phone payment_____(replace) them.

10. …it is predicted that people_____(sit) in front of traditional computers much less than they do now.

11. ... data security_____(become) a huge issue because mobile devices will store so much personal information.

12. ... advertisers_____(put) their adverts on mobile devices rather than on traditional media like TV, magazines, etc.

13. ... we_____(get) accustomed to advertisements which target us directly with personalized messages.

14. ... body sensors connected to our mobile devices_____(provide) us with real-time information about our health.

15.... the problem of short battery life in phones _____(disappear) because phones and mobile devices_____(use) more sophisticated power sources, like kinetic energy.

16. ... mobile phones_____(become) very sophisticated, so that as well as being your diary, address book and music player, you _____(also / use) them as your secretary, accountant and lawyer.

17. ... everyone_____(use) universal translators in their mobile phones, which will make language learning less necessary.

18. ... it is unlikely that we_____(find) a way to use technology to know exactly where people are, because legally it is so difficult.[4]

Translate the following sentences into Italian.

19. The film will have finished before I arrive.

[3] C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, *English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition*, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020 (138)
[4] P. Dummett, J. Hughes, H. Stephenson, *Life Upper Intermediate*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2013 (37)

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20. The shop will be closed tomorrow, so let's go there today.

21. At 10am tomorrow, I will be flying to New York so it's impossible for us to schedule our meeting at that time.

22. A: Why don't you try on that jacket in black instead of grey? B: No, I'll take this one. I have too many black jackets.

23. I'll have lived here 7 years by next Christmas.

24. We will have successfully completed the merger by next summer which means we will be training new staff when the board meets in late September.

25. We believe our research group will have completed the final experiments by Friday and at that point the university dean will be returning from his holiday.

Exercise answer key

1. At 10:00 they will be flying to Geneva.

2. I will have saved 2400 pounds.

3. At 7:00 tomorrow, she will be driving to work.

4. Don't call me at 2:30 because we will be having a meeting.

5. By June, he will have paid for his car.

6. By the end of May, they will be finishing their exams.

7. By the end of this week, she will have written five chapters.

8. She will be working out.

9. …very few people in the developed world **will be using** credit cards because mobile phone payment **will have replaced** them.

10. …it is predicted that people **will be sitting** in front of traditional computers much less than they do now.

11. ... data security **will have become** a huge issue because mobile devices will store so much personal information.

12. ... advertisers **will be putting** their adverts on mobile devices rather than on traditional media like TV, magazines, etc.

13. ... we **will have got** accustomed to advertisements which target us directly with personalized messages.

14. ... body sensors connected to our mobile devices **will be providing** us with real-time information about our health.

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15.... the problem of short battery life in phones will have disappreared because phones and mobile devices **will be using** more sophisticated power sources, like kinetic energy.

16. ... mobile phones **will have become** very sophisticated, so that as well as being your diary, address book and music player, you **will also be using** them as your secretary, accountant and lawyer.

17. ... everyone **will be using** universal translators in their mobile phones, which will make language learning less necessary.

18. ... it is unlikely that we **will have found** a way to use technology to know exactly where people are, because legally it is so difficult.

19. Il film sarà finito prima del mio arrivo / prima che io arrivi.

20. Il negozio sarà chiuso domani, quindi andiamoci oggi.

21. Alle 10:00 di domani sarò in volo per New York, quindi è impossibile fissare il nostro incontro a quell'ora.

22. A: Perché non provi quella giacca in nero invece che in grigio? B: No, prendo questa. Ho troppe giacche nere.

23. Il prossimo Natale avrò vissuto qui 7 anni.

24. Entro la prossima estate avremo completato con successo la fusione, il che significa che formeremo il nuovo personale quando il consiglio si riunirà a fine settembre.

25. Crediamo che il nostro gruppo di ricerca avrà completato gli esperimenti finali entro venerdì e a quel punto il rettore dell'università starà tornando dalle sue vacanze.

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